



CHANGE: REALITY Vs IDEALISM

“Be the change that you want to see in the world”

“Politicise a new breed of leaders who will lead us to the future”

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A hundred years ago, the young generation had ideals. They were united by an idea of a free India ruled, governed and led by Indians. They differed in their methods, so some professed non-violence while others violence; some wanted to free India through revolution while others through evolution. They achieved what they aimed for. In the last 100 years, the world has changed. It has seen the communist revolution in Russia and a revolution against it. The Berlin Wall has been erected and erased. The world has seen India come to being, India divided and now the emergence of India. Today, hundred years later, is the age of idealism dead? I believe that till the time the young breathe, they will not only dream the impossible, but also attempt to achieve it. We just have to believe. The difference between then and now may be that we are not as united in our ideals and idealism as our fathers and great grandfathers were. My idea of how their India needs to go ahead might be different from the idea that the MNS or Raj Thackeray might have, but we are all entitled to these ideals. I want to believe in an India where divisive

politics comprehensively gives way to progressive politics, where there is no scope whatsoever for political debates centred around caste, religion and region. This is the change I want to bring. I want to believe in India which gives equal opportunity to each and every child to pursue a dream, to become what they want to and get what they want irrespective of their caste, family or religion.

There should be equal opportunity in politics too. I am here today because of my surname. I am a product of that system but that system needs to change. When I contested my first elections, nobody knew me. The only qualification I had was my family—great grandfather, grandfather, father—all of whom had been in politics for years. People elected me then but for the next term, I asked people not to vote for my surname, but only for my work. One person who has recognised it more than anybody else is Rahul Gandhi. He's the change that we want. He is willing to give youth equal opportunity. If they want to contribute towards nation building, they can become members of the Youth Congress, contest elections and if they get votes, they will be guaranteed full support. This is what I call a silent revolution. Today it's throwing up a new breed of young politicians. Politicise a new breed of politics and a new breed of leaders who are ready to lead our country to a bright future. The youth needs to remember that change can't wait for some other time and change can't wait for somebody else.